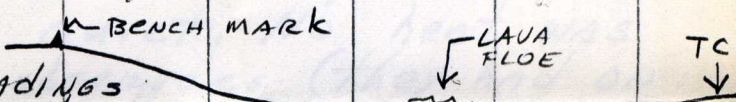


UFO REPORT

On Tuesday, 18 JAN 1966, at 4:55 pm Pacific Std. Time, on Baker Range at the U.S. Naval Ordnance Test Station, two civil service employed surveyors were involved in sighting a UFO. One man was standing at a bench mark monument at $117^{\circ} 49\frac{1}{2}'$ west Longitude $35^{\circ} 52'$ north Latitude at 3004 St above sea level using a Wild T-3 theodolite in a survey of points in the area. Two of their targets were in-line with the BIC flight line, one being a blinking flash lamp about 5 miles S by SSE at a point on the flight line call target central and labeled TC on some maps. A profile of the line of sight to TC is something like:

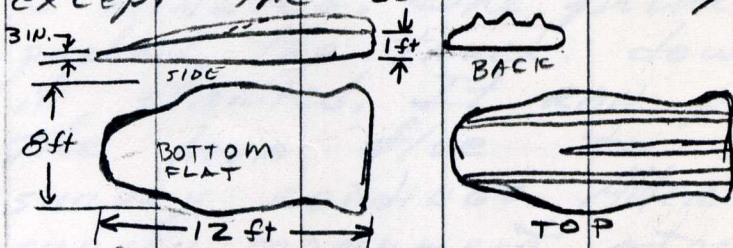


One man was taking readings with the theodolite while the other sat in the truck, a weapons carrier, recording the reading as they were called by the first man. The first man heard a noise described as a "kind of hum" but also like a jet plane cruising at high altitude. He looked up and on backward to see a UFO flying nearly straight at him from an angle of between 35 and 40 degrees and from almost exactly north. He called the second man to "LOOK" as the UFO passed directly overhead at a height of much less than 150 ft. Diving smoothly it appeared to turn slightly to the east and flew to within about 10 ft of the sloping ground, down the flight line but perhaps a constant 10 ft east of the center of the flight line.

After it passed overhead the first observer loosened the elevation lock on the theodolite and aimed the 40x sighting telescope on the UFO, observing it as it

flew down the flight line until its detail became lost in front of the lava flow, about 2 miles away and on the flight line.

Both observers agree the speed was about 150 mph as it passed overhead. Both agree it was a dull black color, there were no noticeable control surfaces, no visible lights, and on the configuration, except the second surveyor noticed only two



fins instead of three. The first man described the UFO as a thing of great beauty in its shape and movement

The noise was very quiet. No heat was experienced by the observers (they had on winter coats). The first observer was somewhat reluctant to report seeing a "wake" behind the UFO. It was as if the rear section was disturbing the surrounding air — something like a plane "dumping fuel" in configuration, like



area on the sketch reality opaque, but was a shock wave seen in apparatus in a wind tunnel. His hesitancy was a result of believing it impossible to see turbulence or shock wave with the unaided eye. Both men agreed on size and that the bottom was flat.

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The men immediately attempted to radio a report into the range control office. Someone in another truck heard their call as very garbled, as if jammed (?). A few words did get through. The operator spoke a few curt words which were received clearly on the surveyors radio. This interference persisted

for perhaps 20 minutes after the UFO passed overhead.

After no success at radio reporting, they attempted to start the truck with no success. The starter motor (24 volts) would barely turn the engine over and the engine would not catch.

They decided to finish their reading from this point and did so in about 5 minutes. They picked up the theodolite and pushed the truck down the hill to get it started. It ran poorly as they drove to the lava flow to make some more survey readings. After climbing to the survey monument atop the lava, they observed that the blinking light at TC was out. From the UFO overflight to this time was less than 20 minutes. They returned to the truck, whose engine they had left in a fast idle, to find the engine now running smoothly.

They drove back to near the point of the overflight, picked up another light, and drove to the TC point. As they approached, the light resumed blinking.

After the overflight, it was necessary to relevel the theodolite. It was observed to be misleveled 5 graduations, having moved toward the west. The first surveyor insists he did not put enough force on the theodolite to cause this mislevel and the plumb string indicated the instrument was still centered over the prick-punch reference on the bench mark. If he had kicked the tripod, the plumb bob would likely be misaligned. Further, with his experience in this operation and the lack of physical movement required to follow the UFO with the telescope, it is very unlikely

that he had exerted any appreciable force on the instrument. No plausible explanation has been offered for the change in the gravity reference indicator - a bubble in a spirit vial.

It is probable that these estimates of size, height, and speed are as reliable as any reported to date because measurement of objects and distances is their daily work. Their integrity is excellent.

A similar UFO was sighted by a NOTS security patrolman who was checking the boundary gate on the Leliter road on the previous Tuesday. It was after dark and the UFO was illuminated but did not have any apparent individual lights. While observing it, the patrolman indicated it suddenly changed direction and quickly accelerated out of sight.